

The CardDAV protocol

Truth be told, you can sync and store contacts in so many ways that it isn't possible to individually fit them into the pages we have left. So let's delve into just one of the strategies here. Regardless of whether you own an Apple or non-Apple device, the contacts syncing is done over a protocol known as 'CardDAV' (<http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/CardDAV>), which is supported by many clients. To sync contacts, you need a server which stores the contacts and supports the CardDAV protocol and a client which can understand the



CardDAV at work

CardDAV protocol. This ensures that the contacts are obtained from the server and any updates to those contacts are pushed as well. If a service provider is as famous as Google, the clients would have the URLs figured out and all you need is a username and password.

There's a good chance that you (or your organisation) use Google's services to sync contacts. In that case, most email clients and smartphones will simply let you enter your Google credentials to sync your contacts. However, if you don't have a Google account, the first requirement to sync your contacts is the ability to publish your contacts list over

the CardDAV protocol. Unfortunately, this won't be possible if your contacts service provider is unwilling to support the protocol. For example, Microsoft with its Outlook.com platforms seems to be unwilling to let anyone access its contacts and calendar services.

Most smartphones are capable of adding most popular calendar services such as that of Apple, Google and Outlook.com. In case your phone doesn't support it right away, you can try adding a 'CardDAV' account. If the OS doesn't support it on its own, you can download and install apps, which enable the functionality (for Android, go to: <http://dgit.in/PlayStoreCardDAV>). Once done, enter the URL for your calendar, and the username and password on the server (which should be your username and password with the service provider) and you're all set. For example, if you have an OwnCloud service running on your own server where you'd like to sync your contacts, you can log in to OwnCloud's web interface. Click on the contacts app on